

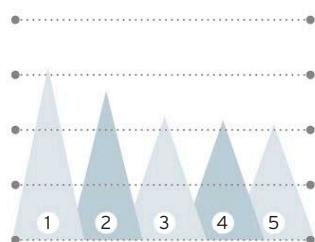


The Alaska Range

The world's highest mountain range outside of Asia and the South American Andes

Stretching for some 400 miles (650 km) like a crescent moon across south-central Alaska, this range appears as an awe-inspiring barrier of high, snow-capped peaks. The loftiest mountains are clustered around Denali, a name given by the local Native American Koyukon people to the highest summit in the Alaska Range. The mountains act as a formidable obstruction to the flow of moist air from the Gulf of Alaska, which lies farther to the south, and—as a result—they experience very high levels of snowfall. Due to this, the valleys in the range are filled with some large glaciers, such as the Black Rapids Glacier (see p.43). These, along with the dramatic Arctic scenery, have made the Alaska Range a magnet for hikers.

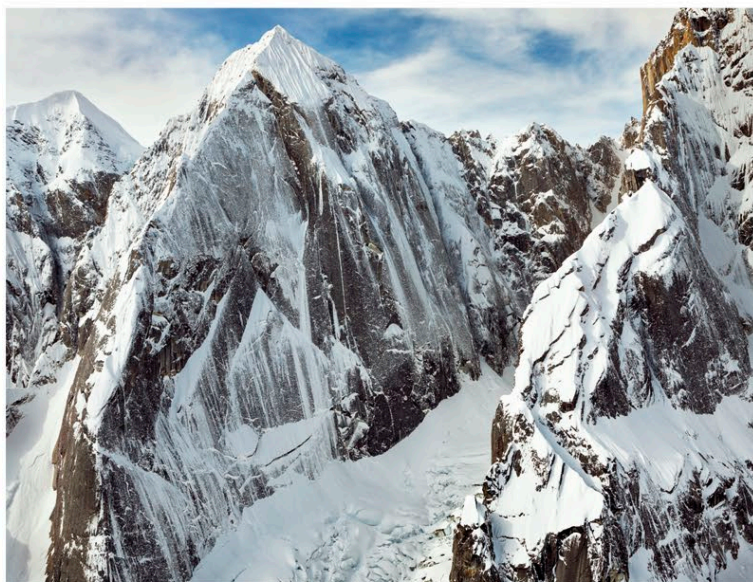
HIGHEST PEAKS IN THE ALASKA RANGE



- 1 Denali 20,308 ft (6,190 m)
- 2 Mt. Foraker 17,402 ft (5,304 m)
- 3 Mt. Hunter 14,574 ft (4,442 m)
- 4 Mt. Hayes 13,832 ft (4,216 m)
- 5 Mt. Silverthrone 13,219 ft (4,029 m)

▽ HIGH POINT

Snow-clad Denali, also known as Mount McKinley, is the highest mountain peak not just in the Alaska Range but in all of North America.



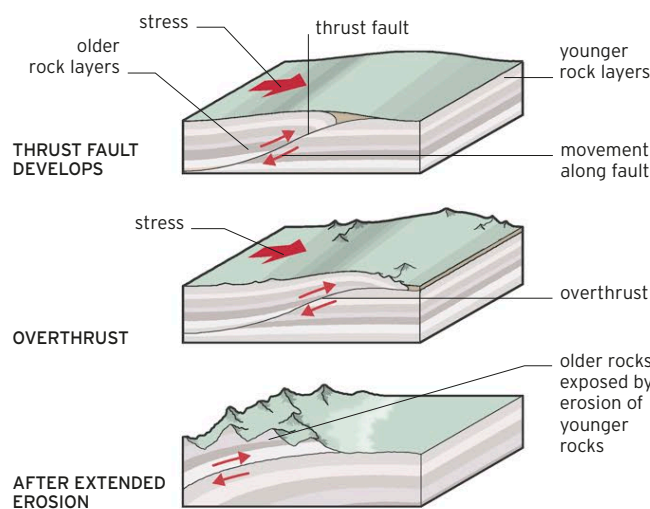
ON THE DIVIDE

Sunburst Peak overlooks Cerulean Lake in the Canadian Rockies. To the left, partially hidden by clouds, Mount Assiniboine lies exactly on the Continental Divide.



THRUST FAULTING

A thrust fault is a break in Earth's crust along which deeper (usually older) layers of rock are pushed up and over shallower layers. An overthrust occurs when they are pushed hundreds of miles forward, too. After erosion, ancient rocks may sit on top of younger layers.



The Rockies boast **more than 100 summits** that are **over 10,000 ft (3,000 m)** high